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7.2.2

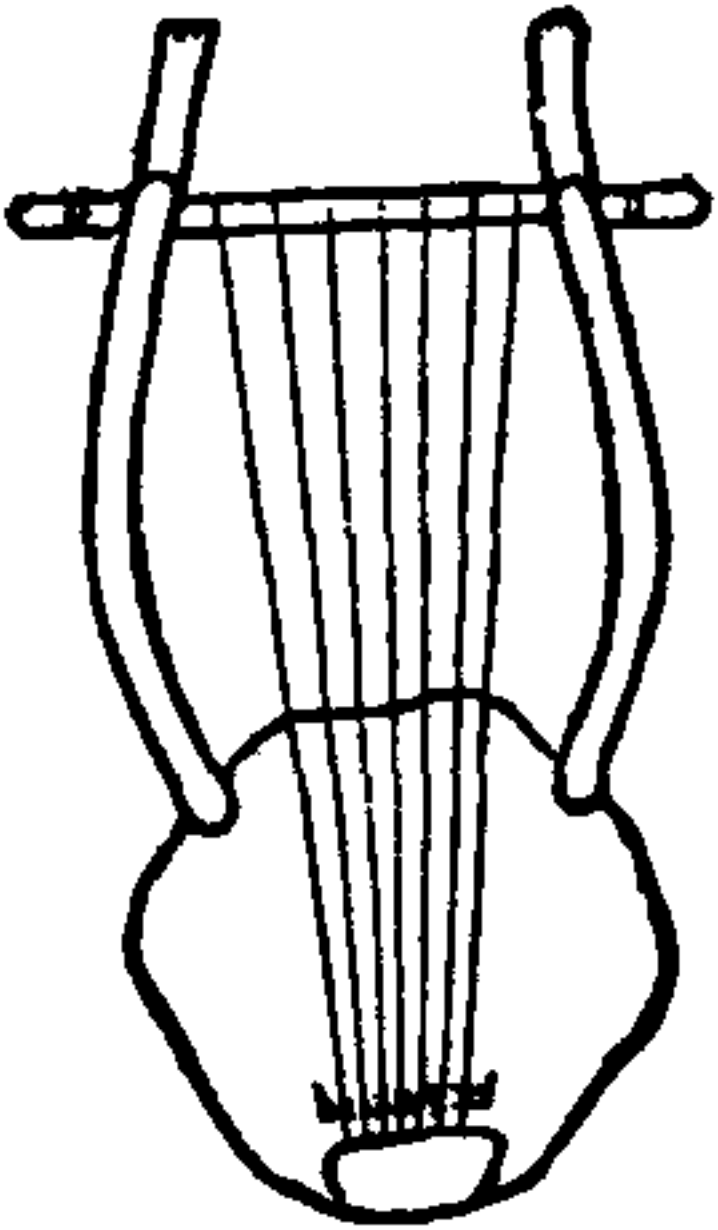
References:

Hebrew כִּנּוֹר (kinor) GEN 4:21, GEN 31:27, 1SA 10:5, 1SA 16:16, 1SA 16:23, 2SA 6:5, 1KI 10:12, 1CH 13:8, 1CH 15:16, 1CH 15:21, 1CH 15:28, 1CH 16:5, 1CH 25:1, 1CH 25:3, 1CH 25:6, 2CH 5:12, 2CH 9:11, 2CH 20:28, 2CH 29:25, NEH 12:27, JOB 21:12, JOB 30:31, PSA 33:2, PSA 43:4, PSA 49:5, PSA 57:9, PSA 71:22, PSA 81:3, PSA 92:4, PSA 98:5, PSA 98:5, PSA 108:3, PSA 137:2, PSA 147:7, PSA 149:3, PSA 150:3, ISA 5:12, ISA 16:11, ISA 23:16, ISA 24:8, ISA 30:32, EZK 26:13

Aramaic שַׁבְּכָא (sabka') DAN 3:5, DAN 3:7, DAN 3:10, DAN 3:15

Greek κινύρα (kinura) SIR 39:15, 1MA 3:45, 1MA 4:54, 1MA 13:51

Description:



Drawing of a lyre (© Public domain - Wikimedia Commons)The lyre consisted of a sound box out of the ends or sides of which projected two arms. The arms supported a crosspiece. Strings descended from the crosspiece over the sound box. As

with the *nevel*, the number of strings could vary. Their varying thickness and tension gave the instrument a range of notes. The lyre was normally made of wood. The strings were made of animal intestines (perhaps from sheep).

Usage:

The strings were normally plucked with the fingers. The *kinor* in particular is frequently depicted as an instrument that accompanied singing.

Translation:

Fresco of a woman playing the lyre (Pompeii, 50–79 CE, British Museum) (© Carole Raddato from FRANKFURT, Germany, CC BY-SA 2.0, via Wikimedia Commons)See 7.2.1 Nevel, large lyre, guitar, harp<REALIA:7.2.1>.

JOB 21:12: For the stringed instrument (*kinor* in Hebrew) accompanying the tambourine, FRCL has "guitar" and *La Bible de Jérusalem* has "zither," which seems to be an instrument used in 1SA 10:5. The first line of this verse may also be rendered "The children sing as people play the tambourine and the lyre." In some languages these instruments will be a local drum

and a stringed instrument; the latter may be a guitar. If no instruments can be found to render any of the instruments in this verse, the translator may have to express the whole verse differently; for example, "The children dance and sing and make joyful sounds/music."

The identity of the instrument called *sabka'* in Aramaic in DAN 3:5; DAN 3:7; DAN 3:10; DAN 3:15 is uncertain. RSV renders it "trigon," which is a small triangular lyre-type instrument with four strings. Probably trigon is technically correct, but it is unknown to the average English reader. GNT has attempted to find a better-known equivalent with "zither," but the zither has far too many strings (over thirty). Some translations use "lyre" for *sabka'* and render the Aramaic word *qathros* before it as "zither" (NIV, NJPSV, NLT). REB has "triangle," but most readers will wrongly identify that as a percussion instrument. CEV avoids the problem by rendering only the first three instruments in the list and grouping the last three together, including *sabka'* as follows: "Trumpets, flutes, harps, and all other kinds of musical instruments."